Band Score

Band 6.0

Question

Governments should spend money on railways rather than roads. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this statement?

Give reasons for your answer and include any relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

Original Essay

Governments spend a alrge amounts of money on different fields, especially the transports. I completely disagree with the opinion that more money should be spent on railways rather than roads, and the government should strike a balance between railways and roads.

It's no doubt that governments are supposed to invest in railways, which are more efficient and convenient in the long distance transports. With the development of science and technology, there are more and more railways and subways constructed in the city, and make us can travel to another city in a very high speed. As for me, I used to going to college from my hometown by car, which took me 6 hours each trip, but it cost me just one hour today with the help of high railways. It is railways that dramatically reduce our transport time and provide a better service.

Although the construction of railways cost a lot of money, there are also several reasons why we should spend money on roads. The transport system of roads play an important in the city, it's the most important method to carry goods and civilians so that we should spend money and time on roads to ensure people's demands. There are more people commute by cars than by subways and trains, so governments should also pay attention to roads to maintain a efficient transport system.

To sum up, I strongly hold the view that government should not just spend money on railways rather than roads. Governments are supposed to maintain roads and develop the railways to keep a better balance.

Sentences

Sentence 1

Original: Governments spend a alrge amounts of money on different fields, especially the transports.

Corrected: Governments spend **large amounts** of money on different fields, especially **transportation**.

Reason:

- Spelling correction: **alrge → large**
- Incorrect article usage: **a large amounts → large amounts**
- More natural noun choice: **the transports → transportation**

Sentence 2

Original: I completely disagree with the opinion that more money should be spent on railways rather than roads, and the government should strike a balance between railways and roads.

Corrected: I completely disagree with the opinion that more money should be spent on railways rather than roads, and **governments** should strike a balance between the two.

Reason:

- “Governments” is more consistent with the topic.
- “The two” avoids repetition and sounds more concise.

Sentence 3

Original: It's no doubt that governments are supposed to invest in railways, which are more efficient and convenient in the long distance transports.

Corrected: **There is no doubt** that governments are supposed to invest in railways, which are more efficient and convenient for **long-distance transportation**.

Reason:

- Incorrect expression: **It's no doubt → There is no doubt**
- Word form correction: **transports → transportation**
- Adjective form needed: **long distance → long-distance**

Sentence 4

Original: With the development of science and technology, there are more and more railways and subways constructed in the city, and make us can travel to another city in a very high speed.

Corrected: With the development of science and technology, more and more railways and subways **have been constructed**, allowing people to travel to other cities at **high speed**.

Reason:

- Incorrect grammar structure: **are constructed**
- Incorrect phrase: **make us can travel**
- More natural expression: **at high speed**
- “People” is more formal than “us” in IELTS essays.

Sentence 5

Original: As for me, I used to going to college from my hometown by car, which took me 6 hours each trip, but it cost me just one hour today with the help of high railways.

Corrected: As for me, I **used to go** to college from my hometown by car, which took me six hours for each trip, but today it takes only one hour with the help of **high-speed railways**.

Reason:

- Grammar correction: **used to going → used to go**
- More formal number style: **6 → six**
- Incorrect vocabulary: **high railways → high-speed railways**
- Better sentence flow and clarity.

Sentence 6

Original: It is railways that dramatically reduce our transport time and provide a better service.

Corrected: Railways dramatically reduce travel time and provide **better services**.

Reason:

- “Travel time” is more natural.
- “Services” is usually plural in this context.
- Simpler sentence structure sounds more academic.

Sentence 7

Original: Although the construction of railways cost a lot of money, there are also several reasons why we should spend money on roads.

Corrected: Although the construction of railways **costs** a lot of money, there are also several reasons why governments should spend money on roads.

Reason:

- Subject-verb agreement: **construction … costs**
- “Governments” is more formal than “we”.

Sentence 8

Original: The transport system of roads play an important in the city, it's the most important method to carry goods and civilians so that we should spend money and time on roads to ensure people's demands.

Corrected: The road transport system **plays an important role** in cities because it is the main method of transporting goods and passengers. Therefore, governments should invest money and time in roads to meet people's needs.

Reason:

- Grammar correction: **play → plays**
- Missing noun: **play an important → play an important role**
- “Civilians” is not suitable here; “passengers” is better.
- Sentence was too long and needed clearer structure.
- More formal vocabulary: **ensure people's demands → meet people's needs**

Sentence 9

Original: There are more people commute by cars than by subways and trains, so governments should also pay attention to roads to maintain a efficient transport system.

Corrected: More people **commute** by car than by subway or train, so governments should also pay attention to roads in order to maintain **an** efficient transport system.

Reason:

- Grammar correction: **people commute**

- Article correction: **a efficient → an efficient**
- More natural comparison structure.

Sentence 10

Original: To sum up, I strongly hold the view that government should not just spend money on railways rather than roads.

Corrected: To sum up, I strongly hold the view that **governments** should not spend money on railways **instead of** roads alone.

Reason:

- Subject agreement: **government → governments**
- Incorrect phrase: **rather than roads**
- Improved clarity and logic.

Sentence 11

Original: Governments are supposed to maintain roads and develop the railways to keep a better balance.

Corrected: Governments are supposed to maintain roads and develop railways in order to achieve a better balance in the transportation system.

Reason:

- Removed unnecessary article: **the railways**
- More academic wording: **achieve a better balance**

Score Improvement and Vocabulary Enhancement

Task Response Improvement

Your opinion is clear throughout the essay, which is good for Task Response. However, your arguments are still quite general. To achieve a higher score, you should:

- Develop each idea in greater detail.
- Explain *why* railways and roads are equally important.
- Include more specific examples or consequences.

For example:

Original:

> Railways dramatically reduce our transport time.

Improved:

> Railways significantly reduce travel time, allowing people to commute more efficiently and boosting economic connections between cities.

Coherence and Cohesion Improvement

Your essay follows the required 4-paragraph structure clearly:

1. Introduction
2. Body Paragraph 1
3. Body Paragraph 2
4. Conclusion

However, cohesion can be improved by:

- Using more linking devices naturally.
- Avoiding overly long sentences.
- Making topic sentences clearer.

Useful linking phrases:

- **On the one hand**
- **On the other hand**
- **Furthermore**
- **As a result**
- **In addition**
- **For instance**

Grammar Improvement

Main grammar problems:

- Subject-verb agreement
- Article usage
- Verb patterns
- Sentence structure

Examples:

Original:

> make us can travel

Corrected:

> allow us to travel

Original:

> cost a lot of money

Corrected:

> costs a considerable amount of money

Vocabulary Enhancement

Case 1

Original: spend money on

Corrected:

- invest in
- allocate funding to
- devote financial resources to

Case 2

Original: convenient

Corrected:

- efficient
- accessible
- time-saving

Case 3

Original: important

Corrected:

- essential
- significant
- crucial

Case 4

Original: better service

Corrected:

- higher-quality transportation services
- more reliable transport systems

Case 5

Original: maintain roads

Corrected:

- improve road infrastructure
- upgrade road networks
- expand transportation facilities

Structure Improvement for a Higher Score

Your current structure is clear, but your body paragraphs could become more academic by using a stronger topic sentence + explanation + example structure.

Recommended Structure

Introduction

- Paraphrase the topic
- Clearly state your opinion

Body Paragraph 1

- Explain advantages of railways
- Give examples and results

Body Paragraph 2

- Explain why roads are still essential
- Mention daily commuting and goods transportation
- Add examples

Conclusion

- Restate opinion clearly
- Summarize both sides briefly

Corrected Essay

Governments invest large amounts of money in different sectors, especially transportation. Although railways are an efficient form of transport, I completely disagree with the idea that governments should spend more money on railways than roads. In my opinion, authorities should maintain a balance between investment in railways and road systems.

There is no doubt that governments should invest in railways because they are efficient and convenient for long-distance transportation. With the development of science and technology, more and more railways and subway systems have been constructed, allowing people to travel between cities at high speed. For example, I used to travel from my hometown to college by car, and the journey took about six hours. However, thanks to high-speed railways, the same trip now takes only one hour. Therefore, railways significantly reduce travel time and improve transportation services.

Although railway construction costs a considerable amount of money, roads are equally important in modern cities. The road transport system plays a crucial role in carrying goods and passengers on a daily basis. In addition, many people still commute by car rather than by train or subway. As a result, governments should continue investing in road infrastructure to meet public demand and maintain an efficient transportation network.

To sum up, I strongly believe that governments should not focus only on railways while ignoring roads. Instead, they should develop both systems equally in order to create a balanced and effective transportation network.